



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident	5 June 2024	Time of Incident	7:40am
Directorate / Region	RMO – Wheatbelt	Main Roads or Contractor	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type	Injury / Illness	EQSafe Incident Number	40956
Actual Consequence	Moderate	Potential Consequence	Moderate

Incident Short Description	Worker rolled ankle on gravel rock, resulting in fracture.
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Executive Summary

At approximately 7:40am, the Injured Person (IP) was exiting the toilet block located at the project site compound.

As the IP has stepped off the last step, their right foot has stood on a gravel rock approximately 80mm in diameter. This has caused the IP to roll their ankle to the right, and then to the left, unbalancing them.

The IP was unable to put any weight on the right ankle and has called out for help. A site engineer has heard and assisted the IP to the site crib room.

A site supervisor was notified and attended to provide preliminary first aid. The IP has appeared to go into shock, with uncontrollable hand shaking and a drop in colour to the face. The supervisor has queried whether the IP was diabetic or had any other medical conditions. The supervisor provided the IP with a warm water and sugar solution for shock treatment. It was noted that the ankle has continued to swell whilst first aid treatment was being provided.

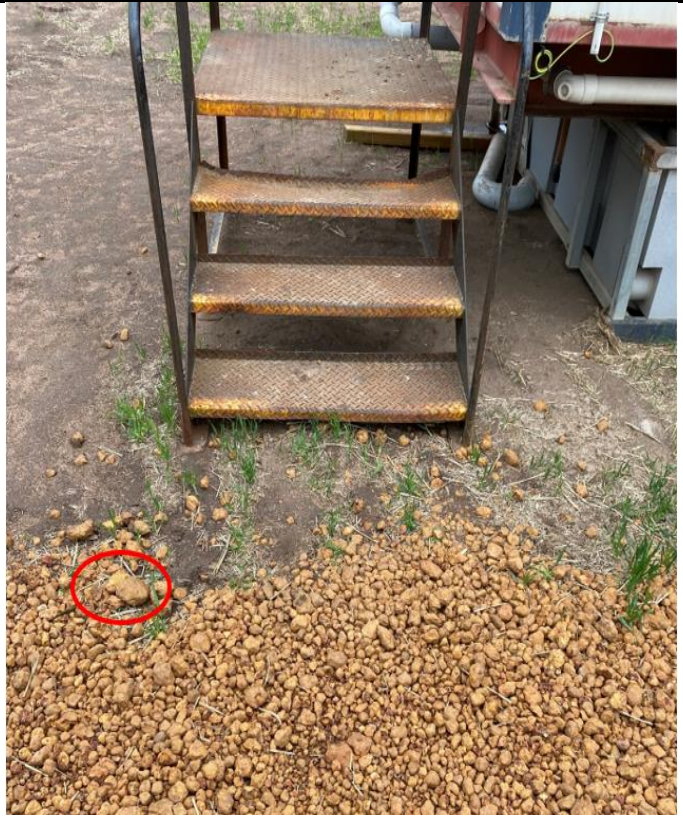
The IP was then conveyed to a hospital for medical assessment. The X-rays confirmed that the injury was a 'Weber A' fracture to the right ankle.

At the time of the injury the IP had been wearing site approved safety boots and had the laces correctly done up to the top. The IP reported no previous injuries or breaks to their right ankle.

Incident Photos



Top view of ankle



Incident scene – position of rock is circled



Post incident: stairs raised and river sand backfill used to create safer path to ablutions

Contributing Factors

- Recent site inspections failed to identify loose larger rocks on the edge of the path to the toilets.
- At the time of the injury, the IP was wearing a mid-ankle style steel cap boot.
- Recent rain has washed fine gravel free, allowing large gravel to be exposed and loose.

Corrective Actions

- Backfill path with rive sand, creating a safer and more level path, and filling up voids cause by rain.
- Prestart notification and discussion held on walking on uneven surfaces and conditions of pedestrian access paths.
- Procure an alternative style of safety boot with better ankle support.

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations